

外研社杯·国才杯·2017 年阅读大赛初赛第三场

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotations. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are three extra options you do not need.

A. Franklin Roosevelt	1. The only limit to our realization of tomorrow will be our doubts of today. 2. There is only one thing in the world worse than being talked about, and that is not being talked about. 3. Other men live to eat, while I eat to live.
B. Francis Bacon	
C. Socrates	
D. Oscar Wilde	
E. Plato	
F. Winston Churchill	

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Oddly in synch with the narrative strategy (though without the imposing visual panache) of *Dunkirk*, the other historical drama of the moment, director Kathryn Bigelow’s *Detroit*, is an artfully frazzled mosaic of suffering, putting the audience through the wringer in the name of truth, injustice and what many see, still, as the American way with police brutality.

4. Where is the piece of text most probably taken from?

- A) a novel B) a poster C) a report D) a review

question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Your speech may, um, help reveal if you’re uh ... developing thinking problems. More pauses, filler words and other verbal changes might be an early sign of mental decline, which can lead to Alzheimer’s disease, a study suggests.

Researchers had people describe a picture they were shown in taped sessions two years apart. Those with early-stage mild cognitive impairment slid much faster on certain verbal skills than those who didn’t develop thinking problems.

5. What is the most probable title of the text?

- A) The Relationship between Speech and Mental Decline. C) The Relationship between Language and Signs.
B) The Relationship between Memory and Speech Problems. D) The Relationship between Words and Thoughts.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

When you eat is important for weight loss. Starving all day and eating a big meal at the end of the day is counterproductive. No matter how nutritious a meal is, if eaten too late in the day, one does not have the time to burn it off and use it for fuel for the day. It ends up being stored in a body gas tank (the fat cells) you can't readily access.

6. Which of the following statements is TRUE according to the text?

- A) Staying away from big meals can burn off fat. C) Eating late at night leads to gaining weight.
B) A nutritious meal leaves excess fat in the body. D) Going on a diet is good for weight loss.

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

To assess the state of drinking water throughout the US, the Environmental Working Group (EWG) obtained data from state agencies and the Environmental Protection Agency for testing conducted from 2010 to 2015. A total of 48,172 utilities from all 50 states were included in the study.

The EWG analysis uncovered 267 contaminants out of the 500 tested drinking water samples. The chemicals included 93 that the EWG says are linked to an increased risk of cancer, 78 that have been tied to brain and nervous system damage, 63 associated with developmental harm to children and fetuses, and dozens of others that may be implicated in fertility or hormonal problems. The levels of the contaminants are not necessarily high enough to cause any of this damage, and many of these links are not proven as causative.

7. Which of the following might be talked about in the next paragraph?

- A) How certain diseases are related to the contaminants. C) Further analyses of the sources of the contaminants.
B) How to get rid of the contaminants in the drinking water. D) The reasons to be worried about the contaminants.

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

If you came of age in the 1980s, chances are you still use the word “tape” when it comes to recording your favorite music or TV shows, as in, “I’m not going to be home tonight to watch *Knight Rider*. Could you tape it for me?” With the advent of digital media, there’s obviously no longer a need to record anything on magnetic tape, but still, old linguistic habits XXXX.

8. Which of the following phrases is the most suitable to replace XXXX?

- A) die hard B) change off C) die out D) change over

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

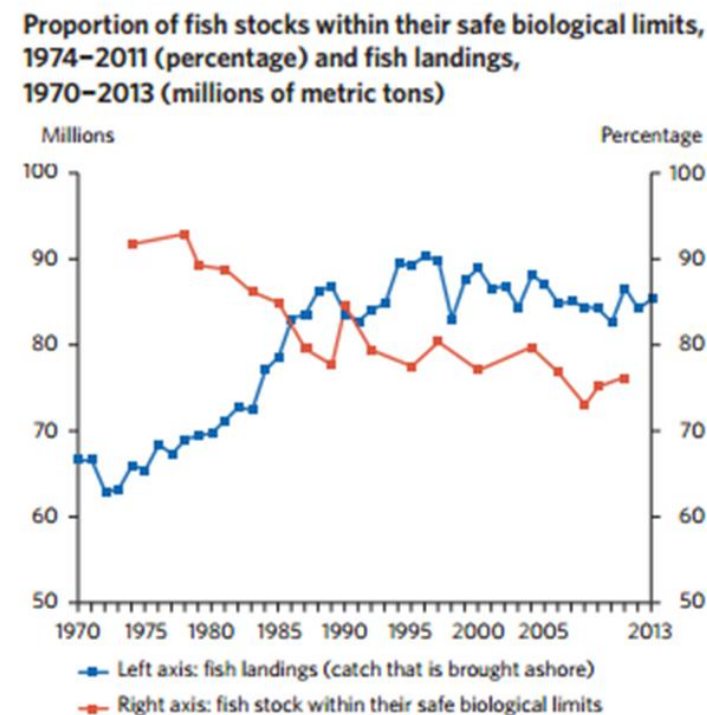
Some parts of the fossil fuel industry will no doubt try to sabotage the electric car revolution. In the United States, the industry is lobbying states to eliminate subsidies for the vehicles. And many analysts expect the industry to seek similar changes at the federal level from President Trump and Republican leaders in Congress, who have already made clear that they do not see climate change as a major threat. They should know, though, that the most they can do is slow down the process. The electric car has already left the garage.

9. What is the author’s point of view about electric cars?

- A) They will sabotage the fossil fuel industry. C) They will pose a major threat to climate.
B) They will become a trend in the future. D) They will not be subsidized by the government.

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The line chart shows the proportion of fish stocks within their safe biological limits from 1974 to 2011 and fish landings from 1970 to 2013. Answer the question according to the information in the chart.



Questions 11-12 (Suggested completion time: 10 minutes)

Directions: Read the definitions of two types of logical fallacy. Answer the questions according to the definitions.

(Source: The Millennium Development Goals Report, 2015).

Sweeping Generalization

In the *sweeping generalization* fallacy, the error lies in making a general statement without qualifying it so that it appears to include all cases. By making a sweeping statement and expecting it to be true in every specific instance, the result is stereotyping. The problem is that the sweeping statement may be true in many cases, but it is not necessarily true in every case. Thus the conclusion would be invalid for those exceptions.

Misleading Vividness

A *misleading vividness* is a fallacy in which anecdotal evidence (or a single vivid image, report, or experience) is offered as proof—in particular, when a small number of dramatic events are allowed to outweigh a significant amount of statistical evidence that supports an opposing view.

10. Choose the INCORRECT description about the chart.

- A) The period from 1990 to 2013 has witnessed the rise of the total marine catch brought ashore globally.
- B) The percentage of fish stocks that remain within safe biological limits has been falling over time.
- C) The chart demonstrates that the global fish catch has an impact on the productivity of fish stocks.
- D) Starting from 1985, fish stocks have been below the level at which they can produce maximum sustainable yields.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of *sweeping generalization*?

A) The universe could not have been created from nothing, so it must have been created by an intelligent life force.

B) Protein is found in meat, poultry, fish, eggs and dairy products, so non-vegetarians get enough protein.

C) There is intelligent life in outer space, for no one has been able to prove that there isn't. I know that every action we perform is predetermined because no one has proved that we have free will.

D) This is the way we have always acted or believed. This is what our ancestors did or believed. Therefore, it is the way we should act or believe.

12. Which of the following provides a typical example of *misleading vividness*?

A) If we don't reduce public spending, our economy will collapse.

B) Since it costs more, it must be better.

C) You should drive on the right side of the road because that is what the law says, and the law is the law.

D) Violent crime is up in our schools. Don't you remember hearing about the awful shooting in that school last month?

Question 13 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

One morning the chairman of a company was leaving on business trip and found he had left some paperwork at his office. He ran into his office to get it and the night watchman stopped him and said, "Sir, don't get on the plane. I had a dream last night that the plane would crash and everyone would die!" The man took his word and canceled his trip. Sure enough the plane crashed and everyone on it died. The next morning the man gave the watchman a \$1,000 reward for saving his life and then fired him.

13. Which is the most probable reason that the chairman fired the watchman?

A) The chairman blamed the watchman for the air crash.

C) The watchman might be a symbol for bad luck.

B) The watchman was fired for sleeping on the job.

D) The chairman was scared of the watchman's intention.

Question 14 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

14. Sylvia the check-out girl is trying to solve a word game. It reads, "Loops is to spool as drawer is to _____".

A) reward B) contents C) bureau

Questions 15-17 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about “petrichor” and answer the questions according to the text.*

Australia’s CSIRO (The Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation) has come up with some pretty amazing inventions over the past 86 years of research, from “polymer banknotes” to “insect repellent” and the world-changing “Wi-Fi”. But we can also lay claim to something a little more esoteric—they actually invented a whole new word.

And no, they’re not talking about one of these new-fangled internet words like “YOLO”, “selfie” or “totes”.

The word is “petrichor”, and it’s used to describe the distinct scent of rain in the air. Or, to be more precise, it’s the name of an oil _____ 15 _____.

This heady smell of oncoming wet weather is something most Australians would be familiar with—in fact, some scientists now suggest that humans inherited an affection for the smell from ancestors who relied on rainy weather for their survival.

Origins

Even the word itself has ancient origins. It’s derived from the Greek “petra” (stone) and “ichor” which, in Greek mythology, is the ethereal blood of the gods.

But the story behind its scientific discovery is a lesser known tale. So, how is it that CSIRO came to find this heavenly blood in the stone?

“Nature of Argillaceous Odour” might be a mouthful, but this was the name of the paper published in the *Nature* journal of March 7, 1964, by CSIRO scientists Isabel Bear and Richard Thomas, that first described petrichor.

Thomas had for years been trying to identify the cause for what was a long-known and widespread phenomenon. As the paper opened: “That many natural dry clays and soils evolve a peculiar and characteristic odour when breathed on, or moistened with water, is recognised by all the earlier text books of mineralogy.”

The odour was particularly prevalent in arid regions and was widely recognised and associated with the first rains after a period of drought.

The paper went on to say: “There is some evidence that drought-stricken cattle respond in a restless matter to this ‘smell of rain’ ”.

The smell had actually been described already by a small perfumery industry operating out of India, which had successfully captured and absorbed the scent in sandalwood oil. They called it “matti ka attar” or “earth perfume”. But its source was still unknown to science.

15. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in the text?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A) that’s released from the earth into the air before rain begins to fall | C) that may explain what makes rain on the Earth |
| B) that has been hydrogenated and is extracted from the soil | D) that has been exposed to warm, dry conditions in the open |

16. What is the text mainly about?

- A) A new perfume which resembles the smell of rain. C) How CSIRO invented a new word about the smell of rain.
B) The words that CSIRO has invented in recent years. D) The origin of a new word from the Greek mythology.

17. What can we learn from the text?

- A) The “earth perfume” is widely used in Australia today. C) “Petrichor” refers to the blood of gods in Greek tales.
B) Our ancestors depended on rainy weather to live. D) CSIRO scientists have written papers about the new perfume.

Questions 18-19 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about smartphone. Answer the questions according to the text.*

No time to kill: How smartphone is pushing chewing gum out of fashion

Smartphone has changed not just the way people communicate but their whole lifestyle. For instance, just 10 years ago photographers were a small community, called shutter bugs, but now smartphone has made everyone a photographer. Smartphone has hit sales of cameras.

While smartphone pushing cameras out is a prominent trend, there are less visible changes that smartphone has brought in our life. One dramatic yet less visible change is fewer people chewing gum these days.

Smartphone is killing chewing gum. According to a market research firm *Euromonitor International*, global gum sales have declined 15 per cent since 2007—the year iPhone came out.

Why?

Smartphone does not leave enough time with people that they would need to while away with gum.

Chewing gum was a favourite way of passing time. Smartphone has filled every little window of free time we used to have before. Use of smartphone has crammed all the pockets of boredom or leisure one had between important jobs or while waiting for something.

According to a report, supermarket checkout lines—strategically stocked with magazines and candy—were for a long time a major point of sale for gum. Consumers waiting in line to pay would look around and make impulse buys.

Now, when people wait, they don't have to look around to find something to make themselves busy with or pass time. _____ 18 _____ Few people would reach for a pack of gum in boredom.

The chewing gum industry is fighting off the smartphone challenge with innovation. Companies keep coming out with variations on the plain-vanilla chewing gum of old times, such as sugar-free gums, gums that also keep the teeth clean and mint gums that are used for deep mouth-freshening.

18. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in the text?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A) Nothing needs to be noticed. | C) They are smarter than before to be kept occupied. |
| B) The chewing gum ads catch all attention. | D) Smartphone is always there. |

19. What can we learn from the text?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A) The chewing gum industry would win through better strategies. | C) The supermarket sales fell dramatically in recent years. |
| B) People are busier than before and don't have time for leisure. | D) Smartphone has made the sales of cameras drop. |

Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the abstract of a research paper. Decide whether the statements are True or False according to the abstract.

Authors: Peijian (Paul) Sun, Lawrence Jun Zhang & Susan M. Gray

Published: *The Asia-Pacific Education Researcher* · March 2016

Abstract: Language learning strategies have drawn researchers' substantial attention since Rubin's (1975) and Stern's (1975) studies on "good language learners". Nevertheless, research pertaining to speaking strategies is inadequate, especially in relation to learning Chinese as second/foreign language (CSL/CFL). This study, therefore, seeks to address this research gap with an initial attempt of developing an inventory for measuring CSL/CFL students' strategies in learning how to speak in L2 Chinese: The Speaking Strategy Inventory for Learners of Chinese (SSILC) as a second/foreign language. Given that this is the very first inventory of its kind, the purpose of our study is to validate it so that more teachers of CSL/CFL could be provided with a tool for assessing their L2 Chinese learners' use and development of speaking strategies. L2 Chinese learners will also be able to use it for monitoring their own progress. Two independent samples of 260 and 135 university L2 Chinese students responded to the SSILC. The data were then subjected to exploratory factor analyses (EFAs) and confirmatory factor analyses (CFAs), respectively. Results from both EFAs and CFAs provided support for a three-factor speaking strategy inventory with good psychometric properties. The three clusters of speaking strategies are *Expression Practice Strategies*, *Native-like and Involvement Strategies*, and *Assistance Strategies*. The correlations between the three clusters of speaking strategies and self-perceived speaking proficiency partially supported the predictive validity of the SSILC. Future research and pedagogical implications for classroom teachers are discussed.

20. Previous studies are inadequate to the strategies for learning Chinese as a second language, which is one of the reasons of the current research.

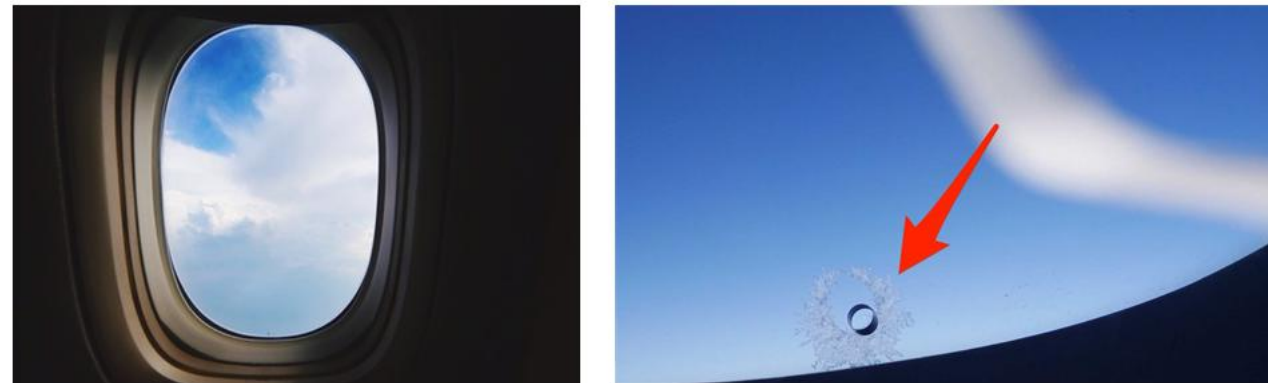
A) True B) False

21. EFAs is the next step after CFAs to provide support for a three-factor speaking strategy inventory with good psychometric properties.

A) True B) False

Questions 22-23 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about the tiny holes on airplane windows. Answer the questions according to the text.



Why Do Airplane Windows Have Tiny Holes?

It's probably not what you think.

We've long espoused the benefits of booking the window seat, but spending enough time there, looking out of that more-or-less 9 x 12.5 inch quasi-rectangle, you'll begin to notice some things. How small the world looks from above. How the plane's wings glide through the clouds. Another thing? A tiny hole.

The hole isn't just there for aesthetic disruption. Instead, the hole—tiny as it may be—22. It all comes down to pressure: the higher the altitude, the lower the oxygen, which can leave people feeling ill and short of breath. (This will be a familiar experience, for example, for anyone who has recently climbed a mountain.) At a cruising altitude of 35,000 feet, the air pressure is so low that anyone would pass out if they were exposed to it, so a plane's cabin must be pressurized to be much greater than the outside air, reports *The Telegraph*. Good for passengers, yes, but not so great for the plane, which needs a way to release some of the strain this puts on the aircraft.

Look closely at your window, and you'll see that it's not just made up of one durable pane, but three. According to Mark Vanhoenacker, a British Airways pilot who writes for *Slate*, the innermost pane is mostly to protect the second and third panes, which are "designed to contain this difference in pressure between the cabin and the sky." The hole, then, allows pressure

to be balanced out between the cabin and gap between panes. Another function of the airplane window hole? To release moisture and minimize the frost or condensation blocking your view. That' s good news for your Instagram.

22. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in the text?

- | | |
|--|----------------------------------|
| A) keeps passengers safe | C) is for better air circulation |
| B) is designed according to certain laws | D) keeps the window fog-free |

23. What can be inferred from the text?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A) The window seat has been people' s preference when taking the airplane. | C) The tiny holes in the windows are more beneficial to the airplanes than to the passengers. |
| B) There are two panes in the airplane windows for multi-functions. | D) A plane' s cabin should be kept at the same pressure level as the outside air. |

Questions 24-31 (Suggested completion time: 30 minutes)

Directions: *Read three passages about the sharing economy. Answer the questions according to the passages.*

Passage A

Bike-sharing startups in China sport a parade of colorful branding for their nifty-looking bikes—orange for Mobike and yellow for ofo, to name two market leaders among some 30 companies that have jumped into this sector. The race is on for dominance just as it has been with taxi-hailing services.

Mobike has drawn more than \$300 million from Temasek, Hillhouse Capital, Sequoia Capital and Tencent' s Xuanwu Lab. ofo, its chief rival, has attracted \$450 million from Didi Chuxing and DST—not to mention a plug by Apple CEO Tim Cook, who recently visited and rode a bike at ofo.

You might say, bike sharing is nothing all that new or exciting. After all, bike-sharing services have popped up in New York City and London.

But the business model and technology for bike sharing in China is more advanced than in the West—one more sign of that skillful Chinese micro-innovating gene. In China, you can drop your rented bike wherever you want to instead of at an assigned docking station—thanks to GPS technology that locates and tracks the position for each bicycle.

In Beijing and Shanghai, bikes are being dropped randomly at street corners, subway stations, campuses, restaurants, shopping malls and you name it. These branded bikes are starting to crowd city sidewalks so much now that talk is that government regulations could be coming to control parking of the bikes only in authorized specific zones.

Just as with Uber and Didi, you can bet that this new startup craze will see price wars and battles to the finish to win—whether it' s an acquisition or an IPO (initial public offering: a company' s first stock offering to the public). Already, these bike-sharing entrants are trying out new business tactics to tackle some of the challenges of bike-sharing efficiency.

On a panel I moderated recently at Peking University, Mobike CTO (Chief Technology Officer) and co-founder Joe Xia said the company is having initial success with a recently introduced red packet promotion that rewards bikers for returning their bikes to a designated parking spot. Clever!

The bike-sharing services are starting to go global too—at least where flat landscapes and city density makes bicycles a popular form of transportation. Mobike is venturing outside China by entering the Singapore market. To be sure, Mobike does not have an open road—it will compete with Singapore’s own O Bike, as other Asian markets begin to adapt this new startup trend.

Passage B

Most sharing economy websites advertise their green credentials, and many users care about their ecological impact. The ecological benefits of sharing are often seen as obvious: secondary markets reduce demand for new goods, so footprints go down. Staying in existing homes reduces the demand for new hotels just as tool-sharing reduces new tool purchases. However, despite the widespread belief that the sector helps to reduce carbon emissions, there are almost no comprehensive studies of its impact. At this point, they are long overdue.

An exception is a recent study of car-sharing. It found a measurable reduction in greenhouse gas emissions, but only because of substantial reductions from a small fraction of households. For the majority, car-sharing, by expanding access to cars, increased emissions.

The ordinary assumptions about ecological impacts are generally about the first, visible shifts made by a consumer—purchasing used products rather than new ones, or staying in a private home rather than a hotel. To assess overall ecological impacts, however, we have to consider ripple effects. What does the seller or the host do with the money earned? She may use the money to buy high-impact products. Does the appearance of a market for used goods lead people to buy more new things that they intend to sell later? If travel becomes less expensive, do people do more of it? All of these effects raise ecological and carbon footprints.

There is also the question of impacts at the level of the economy as a whole. The platforms are creating new markets that expand the volume of commerce and boost purchasing power. The larger, for-profit companies are claiming to generate substantial business and income for their providers. If so, they are likely to create economic activity that would not have existed otherwise—more travel, more private automobile rides—and not just shifting purchasing from one type of provider to another. My students and I have found that Airbnb users are taking more trips now and that the availability of cheap ride services is diverting some people from public transportation. That means the platforms result in higher carbon emissions, because their services use energy. The companies can’t have it both ways—creating new economic activity and reducing carbon emissions—because the two are closely linked.

Passage C

The uniqueness of the sharing economy poses several new challenges for regulators in countries across the world. The inherent objective of regulating such sectors is to encourage competition that will eventually lead to innovation, lower costs, and better products and services.

Regulators are inherently reactive, and very slow to respond to changes in the sharing economy. ____28____

In the digital age, technological advancements bring increasing efficiency. However, existing regulatory organizing bodies lack coordination between the different levels of the government. The lack of a collaborative system results in confused mixes of policies that trickle down through official levels. One such example is Uber being branded as an illegal “bandit taxi-service” in the city of Ottawa. Municipal employees are not provided reimbursement if travelling by an Uber, even though their travel allowance covers licensed taxis. In the Canadian federal government, policy responses are not yet concrete even though they are aware that their own employees take Uber to get to work. Political parties have not identified an approach to regulating the sharing economy.

In India, the High Court of Delhi has asked the government of India to develop guidelines for regulating taxi cab aggregators. This is an important exercise which needs to be based on real world data and also needs a simple enforcement mechanism. The more stringent the regulatory guidelines, the higher the regulatory capacity must be to monitor and enforce these guidelines.

Regulation should only be changed when there is an immediate need, such as market failure. There is no such need for the sharing economy.

Commercial activities in the sharing economy blur lines between the personal and professional. For example, most Airbnb hosts are not professional hoteliers, and a large fraction of Lyft and Uber drivers are not professional drivers and are only active on the platform fewer than fifteen hours per week. Applying a regulatory regime to these businesses might create an entry barrier. Absence of regulations, on the other hand, can lead to more part-time supply and that forms part of a self-regulatory solution.

24. According to Passage A, what makes the bike sharing in China different from the West?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--|
| A) The number of bikes is enormous. | C) The bikes are attractive in appearance. |
| B) It is very cheap to rent a bike. | D) No assigned docking station is needed. |

25. What kind of attitude does the author have towards the red packet promotion introduced by Mobike in Passage A?

- A) Skeptical. B) Ambivalent. C) Critical. D) Favorable.

26. It can be inferred from Passage B that car-sharing business may increase carbon emissions because _____.

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| A) private cars will be used more | C) taxi drivers will work longer hours |
| B) more cars will be purchased | D) people will travel a lot more |

27. The author of Passage B holds the following views EXCEPT that _____.

- | | |
|---|---|
| A) more comprehensive studies should have been done | C) carbon emission will be increased by sharing economy |
|---|---|

-
- B) sharing economy has created more economic activities D) most people overlook the impact of sharing economy

28. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in Passage C?

- A) They are reluctant to do so. C) They play a catch-up role.
B) They find it unnecessary. D) They need more data.

29. According to Passage C, we can infer that the regulation the sharing economy needs should _____.

- A) create more part-time jobs B) encourage competition C) establish entry barriers D) quickly respond to changes

30. Which of the following types of sharing economy is mentioned in all three passages?

- A) Tool sharing. B) Home sharing. C) Bike sharing. D) Car sharing.

31. Which of the following statements about sharing economy is TRUE according to the three passages?

- A) Authority regulations are badly needed for sharing economy. C) China has become a leading country in sharing economy.
B) Sharing economy brings about challenges as well as chances. D) Uber, Airbnb and Mobike have been successful worldwide.